MODULE 0

CASE STUDY

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A €24B German fintech that fooled the system — and what it teaches about startup metrics

Prepare this case before class. Come ready to take a position.

THE SITUATION

Wirecard AG, 2019

THE SITUATION

Juicero, winter 2015–16

Doug Evans has spent two years and serious capital engineering a beautiful Wi-Fi juicer: custom press, machined parts, DRM-scanned produce packs. Kleiner Perkins and Google Ventures are in for ~$120M. Launch is weeks away at $699.

KEY FACTS

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- ~$120M raised (2014–2017)
- Launch price: $699 + subscription packs
- 2 years of hardware engineering
- No demand test without the machine
- April 2017: Bloomberg squeezes the bag by hand

THE DECISION

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OPTION A

OPTION A

OPTION B

OPTION B

OPTION C

OPTION C

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Come prepared to defend your position with evidence from the case.

1. DISCUSSION QUESTIONS
2. Come prepared to defend your position with evidence from the case.
3. What was Juicero's actual hypothesis — and what would the €0 test of it have been?
4. Why did $120M of smart money not demand that test? What does the money change?